PRACTICAL GUIDE

Designing labels for organic products

From reference analysis and Canva setup to AI illustration and print-ready export. Worked example: the “Natural Loofah” label (luffa sponge).

Label size 11.112 × 15.416 cm · **Version** 2.0 · 03 Nov 2026

Cormorant Garamond · Open Sans · JetBrains Mono

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How to use this guide. Read sections 1 to 3 for the framework, then work through sections 4 to 9 in order. Section 10 is the reusable command set, section 11 is for troubleshooting, and section 12 is the pre-print checklist.

1. Process overview

This guide documents the process used to produce the “Natural Loofah” label (luffa sponge): analysing a reference label, generating illustrations with AI, designing in Canva, and exporting print-ready files. Every step is repeatable for another product; only the content and the illustration change.

1 Analyse the reference label | 2 Write the label “formula” | 3 Generate the illustration | 4 Design in Canva | 5 Build in HTML/CSS (fallback) | 6 Export and save files | 7 Legal and barcode review

Step	Task	Tool	Output
1	Analyse your reference label (front and back)	Canva (read design), Claude	Breakdown of layout, colour and content
2	Write a reusable label “formula”	Claude Docs	7-lesson course with checklist
3	Generate a botanical engraving illustration	Canva AI Image (generate-image)	Sage-green artwork, no background, no text
4	Design the two-sided label	Canva (create-design)	Editable Canva design
5	Build a print-accurate version (fallback)	HTML/CSS and Python Playwright	PNG at about 300 dpi, PDF, SVG
6	Export and save files	Canva Export, Downloads folder	PNG and PDF for print
7	Review legal content and barcode	Checklist	Files ready for the printer

Guiding principle. One system of 4 tiers on the front (illustration, name, information, badge) and 5 blocks on the back (product information, ingredients, usage, caution, manufacturer with barcode), with one fixed 9-colour palette, kept identical for every product.

2. The standard label system

Every product uses the same frame. Only the content, the name and the illustration change.

Specification	
Size	11.112 × 15.416 cm, portrait. Safe margin of at least 3 mm; 3 mm bleed if the printer requires it.
Fonts	Cormorant Garamond (serif) for headings; Open Sans (sans-serif) for body text.
Text colour	Body text in dark brown `#3A3120`; small headings in `#5C4519`.

The 9-colour palette

Sage background
#B8C39F · background

Sage illustration
#7E8D63 · artwork

Cream
#F4EEDC · name band

Warm gold
#A67C3E · title

Deep gold
#8A6732 · accent

Olive
#6F7D58 · decoration

Rule line
#B08A4D · decoration

Badge
#B28135 · badge fill

Badge text
#F7F1E5 · text on badge

CONTRAST (RECALCULATED WITH THE WCAG FORMULA)

Colour pair	Ratio	Suitable for
Dark brown `#3A3120` on sage `#B8C39F`	**6.92 : 1**	Body text (passes)
Brown `#5C4519` on sage	**4.89 : 1**	Small headings (passes)
Olive `#6F7D58` on sage	**2.39 : 1**	**Not for text**, decoration only
Deep gold `#8A6732` on sage	**2.79 : 1**	**Not for text**, decoration only
Warm gold `#A67C3E` on cream `#F4EEDC`	**3.25 : 1**	Large text only (the product title)
Badge text `#F7F1E5` on `#B28135`	**3.07 : 1**	Large bold text inside the badge

Note. Small body text on sage is always dark brown `#3A3120`. Never use olive or deep gold for small text.

3. Structure of the two sides



Front, 4 tiers

FRONT, 4 TIERS

1. **Illustration:** tone-on-tone botanical engraving, about 52% of the height.
2. **Name band:** cream, about 35%. Large product name (serif, warm gold), thin gold rule and a small ornament.
3. **Information band:** sage, about 13%. Full name and quantity; botanical name (italic) and product type.
4. **Round badge:** "100% NATURAL", top right. Use only when substantiated.



Back, 5 blocks, 2 columns

BACK, 5 BLOCKS

1. **About this product.**
2. **Ingredients,** with tick marks.
3. **How to use,** step by step, with storage.
4. **Caution,** full width.
5. **Manufacturer, country of origin, barcode,** in a cream box. If there is no real code yet, write "BARCODE (replace with real code)".

4. Preparation and tool connections

4.1 What you need

- A **Claude** account (Cowork interface on the web) with connectors enabled.
- A **Canva** account. Canva Pro is recommended for high-quality PNG export and transparent backgrounds.
- A Windows or Mac computer running Claude Desktop, if you want files saved straight to a folder.
- Chrome with the Claude in Chrome extension (optional) to read Canva designs as web pages.

4.2 Connect Canva to Claude

1. Go to **Settings → Connectors** in Claude, find **Canva** and click **Connect**.
2. Sign in to Canva and allow permission to read, create and export designs. Grant access only for your own account.
3. Open a new conversation and test with:

   ```
   Read this Canva design and summarise its components: <paste design link>
   ```

   If Claude returns the content or a preview image, the connection works.

4.3 Connect a folder on your computer (so files save locally)

1. Open Claude Desktop and choose **Link to this computer** for the conversation.
2. When Claude asks for access to a folder (for example **Downloads**), click **Allow**. The permission applies to the current session only.
3. Ask:

   ```
   Save the label files to my Downloads folder.
   ```

   Claude writes the files and reports their names.

If you do not link your computer, files still appear in the conversation so you can download them.

5. Steps 1–2: Analyse the reference and write the formula

5.1 Analyse the reference label

Paste the link to your Canva design and use this command:

```
Based on the design in this Canva file, analyse and break down every component on the front and the back: layout, colours, fonts, design approach and the content of each part. Draw lessons I can use to study how to design packaging for products.
```

Claude reads the content and the preview image of each page, then analyses each tier and each block. Any figure that has not been measured (colour counts, proportions) is **measured first and stated afterwards**, never estimated.

Specification extracted from the reference	
Size	11.112 × 15.416 cm, portrait
Front	4 tiers: illustration about 52% · cream name band about 35% · information band about 13% · round “100% NATURAL” badge top right
Back	5 blocks, 2 columns: product information · ingredients (with ✓) · how to use (steps) · caution (full width) · manufacturer with barcode
Palette	9 colours (see section 2)
Fonts	Serif for headings, sans-serif for body text

5.2 Write the “formula” document

```
Based on my designs, create a document that consolidates the label design formula for organic products in general, for teaching: clear, professional, with lessons, case studies, a checklist and exercises.
```

The result is a 7-lesson course, “Label design for organic products”, in Claude Docs. From here on, every new label follows that document.

Regulations to verify. USDA (4 organic categories), EU (mandatory organic logo), Vietnam: Decrees 109/2018/ND-CP and 43/2017/ND-CP on labelling. Confirm with the certification body before printing.

6. Step 3: Generate the illustration with Canva AI

Use Canva's image tool (`generate-image`) with aspect ratio `LANDSCAPE_4_3`, which suits the illustration area (about 52% of the front). The original prompt written for a guava plant, adapted to luffa:

```
Transform the reference plant into a premium botanical engraving illustration. Medicinal herb
botanical illustration of loofah (luffa cylindrica) with vine, leaves, yellow flower, young green
gourds and a dried loofah sponge piece, detailed scientific plant drawing, vintage herbal engraving
style, hand-drawn botanical artwork, monochromatic sage green palette, tone-on-tone green
illustration, highly detailed leaves, stems and small gourds, elegant contour linework, fine etched
shading, Victorian botanical plate aesthetic, antique medicinal plant illustration, luxury natural
packaging artwork, botanical apothecary design, clean vector engraving, isolated composition,
realistic plant structure, delicate line art, premium natural wellness branding, botanical specimen
drawing, subtle crosshatching, professional vector artwork, centered composition, no background, no
text, no label, transparent background. #7E8D63
```

Formula for an illustration prompt

Part	Example
Subject	[plant] and the parts to include (stem, leaves, flower, fruit)
Style	vintage herbal engraving, Victorian botanical plate, crosshatching
Colour	monochromatic sage green, tone-on-tone, colour code `#7E8D63`
Composition	isolated, centered, no background, no text, no label
Aspect ratio	LANDSCAPE_4_3 (fits the illustration area, about 52% of the front)

Procedure

1. Send the prompt. The image tool runs in the background; Claude polls the job (`get-generate-image-job`) and returns an **Open generated image** link.
2. Open the link and choose the best version.
3. **Download the original from Canva** and check sharpness before printing.

Caution. The preview is only about 200 px wide, and on transparent images the checkerboard is a simulation. Do not judge print quality from the preview. If the artwork is not sharp enough, switch to the vector illustration in step 5.

7. Step 4: Design the label directly in Canva

Use the design command (`create-design`) with a complete brief. The more specific the brief, the more accurately Canva builds it. Sample brief for “Natural Loofah”:

```
Product label for "Natural Loofah" (luffa sponge), portrait custom size 11.112 x 15.416 cm, English.
FRONT: sage green (#B8C39F) top ~52% with a tone-on-tone botanical engraving illustration (#7E8D63);
circular badge top-right "100% NATURAL" (gold #B28135, text #F7F1E5);
middle ~35% ivory (#F4EEDC) band with large serif title "Natural Loofah" in warm gold (#A67C3E), thin
gold rule;
bottom ~13% sage band: "Natural Loofah Sponge | Quantity: 1 pc" / "Luffa cylindrica | Plant-fibre
sponge".
BACK: sage background, 2 columns: About this product; Ingredients (✓ Plant fibre only, Reusable many
times, Biodegradable);
How to use (Step 1-4); Caution; Manufacturer: <name, address>; Country of origin: ____; barcode
placeholder box.
Dark brown text (#3A3120). Premium organic apothecary style, 2 pages (front, back).
```

After Canva finishes

1. Canva returns a **design link** (editable). Open it and **check both pages**. Claude can read each page’s preview to cross-check.
2. Check the size. Canva sometimes builds a **landscape** page instead of portrait. If so: **Resize → Custom size** 111.12 × 154.16 mm.
3. To use your own AI illustration: choose **Uploads** or **Apps → Create image**, then place the image in the front-page frame.
4. Turn on **Show rulers & guides** and set a safe margin of about 3 mm; add a 3 mm bleed if the printer requires it.

> The page-2 preview may not be available right away. Retry after a few minutes, or open the design link to view it directly.

8. Step 5: Build a print-accurate version in HTML/CSS (fallback)

Use this when you need exact control of size, colour and fonts, or when Canva's result is not right. The label is built in HTML with millimetre units and exported with Chromium (Playwright).

Canva or HTML/CSS

	Canva (step 4)	HTML/CSS (step 5)
Use when	You need quick edits and prefer drag-and-drop	You need exact size, colour and fonts, or a vector file for print
Strengths	Easy manual edits, team collaboration	Exactly 111.12 × 154.16 mm, repeatable, independent of Canva
Limits	May build the wrong size (landscape instead of portrait); file downloads are sometimes blocked	Requires running code; manual edits are harder

Component	Method
Vector illustration	A Python script generates an SVG (leaves, fruit, flower, tendrils, luffa sponge) with a fixed seed so the result is repeatable
Layout	HTML/CSS in millimetres: each side is one 111.12 × 154.16 mm block; set `html` and `body` to the sage colour so no white edge shows
Fonts	Cormorant Garamond (headings), Open Sans (body), installed with npm `@fontsource`
Image export	Playwright with `device_scale_factor` 3.125 for about 300 dpi

General commands

```
# 1. Install the libraries (once)
pip install playwright --break-system-packages
npm install @fontsource/cormorant-garamond @fontsource/open-sans

# 2. Generate the SVG illustration and build the HTML
python3 illustration.py        # → illustration.svg
python3 build_en.py            # → label_en.html (front + back)

# 3. Export PNG (300 dpi) + PDF
python3 render_en.py ./out pdf
# → natural-loofah_label_front_EN.png, ..._back_EN.png, natural-loofah_label_EN.pdf
```

CORE EXPORT CODE (ABRIDGED)

```
pg = await browser.new_page(viewport={'width':440,'height':600}, device_scale_factor=3.125)
await pg.goto('file://label_en.html'); await pg.evaluate('document.fonts.ready')
await pg.locator('#front').screenshot(path='front.png')
await pg.locator('#back').screenshot(path='back.png')
await pg.pdf(path='label.pdf', width='111.12mm', height='154.16mm', print_background=True)
```

Checks after building

- No overlapping text, especially the curved text around the badge.
- No artwork overlapping the title.
- No large empty areas on the back.

This route does not need Canva and gives vector PDF/SVG files ready for print. In return, manual editing is easier in Canva.

9. Steps 6–7: Export, save locally, hand over to the printer

9.1 Export from Canva

1. Open the design → **Share** → **Download**.
2. Choose **PNG** (high quality, select all pages) or **PDF Print** (Canva can add bleed and crop marks).
3. If you ask Claude to export:

   ```
   Export this design as high-quality PNG, all pages, and save it to Downloads.
   ```

If the environment blocks the export download (error 403), do not try to bypass it. Use the design link and download manually: Share → Download → PNG or PDF. Likewise, if Claude cannot upload an image to Canva, upload it yourself.

9.2 Save locally

With a linked computer, Claude writes the files to the folder you allowed (for example Downloads) and reports the file names. If linking fails, click to download the files directly from the conversation.

9.3 Print hand-over package

File	Used for
label_front.png, label_back.png (300 dpi)	Review and approval; some printers accept them directly
label.pdf (2 pages)	Send to the printer
illustration.svg	Edit or reprint the illustration

10. Reusable command set

Replace the parts in [square brackets] for a new product.

Command A: Generate the illustration

```
Create a botanical engraving for [plant/product] with the following prompt, landscape 4:3:
Transform the reference plant into a premium botanical engraving illustration. Botanical illustration
of [English/Latin name] with [leaves, flowers, fruit...], vintage herbal engraving style,
monochromatic sage green palette, tone-on-tone, elegant contour linework, subtle crosshatching,
isolated, centered, no background, no text, no label, transparent background. #7E8D63
```

Command B: Design the label in Canva

```
Using the label formula (size 11.112 x 15.416 cm, 4 front tiers, 5 back blocks, 9-colour palette),
design a label in [English/Vietnamese] for the product [name] in Canva, 2 pages (front/back).
Content: name [..]; quantity [..]; ingredients [..]; how to use [..]; caution [..]; manufacturer
[name, address]; origin [..]; barcode [placeholder/real code].
Use the illustration just created for the front. Text in dark brown #3A3120 for legibility.
```

Command C: Check and export

```
Open this Canva design, show me a preview of each page, check the size, spelling errors and contrast;
then export high-quality PNG and PDF and save them to the Downloads folder.
```

Command D: Build the print-accurate fallback

```
Rebuild this label in HTML/CSS at 111.12 x 154.16 mm, export 300 dpi PNG for both sides and a 2-page
PDF, show them on screen, then save to Downloads.
```

11. Common problems and how to fix them

Problems encountered while making the luffa label.

Symptom	Cause	Fix
AI image only about 200 px, with a checkerboard	It is a preview, not the original file	Download the original from Canva; check sharpness before printing; if it is not sharp enough, use the vector illustration
Canva builds the label in landscape	The custom-size brief was not applied exactly	Resize → custom 111.12 × 154.16 mm, or ask Claude to rebuild
Page 2 has no preview	Canva has not stored a thumbnail for the new page	Open the design link to view directly; retry after a few minutes
Claude cannot upload an image to Canva (error 403)	Claude's working environment blocks the connection to Canva's upload and download servers	Upload the image to Canva yourself (Uploads → choose file), or download the PNG from Canva yourself (Share → Download)
Text hard to read on sage	Olive or deep gold text has low contrast	Use `#3A3120` for body text and `#5C4519` for small headings
Edges or colours shift in print	Screen RGB differs from the printer's CMYK	Print one proof; adjust colours against the real print
"Cannot parse JSON" error when creating a long document	Too much content sent at once	Split into parts (2 to 4 items at a time)

12. Pre-print checklist and content to confirm

Pre-print checklist

☐ Size exactly 111.12 × 154.16 mm, safe margin of at least 3 mm, 3 mm bleed if the printer requires it

☐ Illustration sharp enough (at least 300 dpi at print size)

☐ All text correctly spelled and in the right language

☐ Text-to-background contrast is sufficient

☐ Real barcode, scan-tested

☐ One proof printed, colours compared, small text legible

Content the product owner must confirm

Claude **does not assert** the items below. If unknown, leave them blank or as a placeholder and ask.

Item	Status in the reference label
Quantity "1 pc"	Assumed, needs confirmation
4-step usage instructions and cautions	Written by convention, needs review
"100% Natural", "Reusable", "Biodegradable", "Organic"	Needs substantiation before printing
Country of origin	Left blank
Barcode	Placeholder box, needs a real code
Brand name and logo	Not added
Legal labelling (VN, EU, USDA if exporting)	Verify against current regulations

This document describes a process that was carried out and does not replace legal advice on product labelling.